

Leona Chen

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EDUCATION

The Pennsylvania State University | Schreyer Honors College

Bachelor's in Computer Science & Mathematics | GPA: 3.74/4.00

University Park, PA

Graduation May 2027

Relevant Courses: Data Structures, Object-Oriented Programming, AI, Systems Programming, Computer Vision

SKILLS

Programming Languages: Java, Python, C, Javascript, Swift, MATLAB, SQL, HTML/CSS, R, LaTeX, Lua

Frameworks & Libraries: React.js, React Native, NumPy, pandas, Tkinter, ChromA, p5.js, Swing, LangChain, TensorFlow

Technologies & Tools: VS Code, Linux, Xcode, Google Colab, Git, Hugging Face, Microsoft Office, Power BI, Firebase

WORK EXPERIENCE

GameChanger

New York, NY

Software Engineering Intern - Fan Experience

June 2026 - Present

- Developed cross-platform SDUI home screen with a versioned API and resilient client handling
- Built and maintained full-stack features across React/TypeScript frontends and backend API services
- Cleaned up technical debt and maintained automated test coverage under strict lint and CI/CD standards

IBM

State College, PA

Associate Application Developer Co-Op

January 2026 - May 2026

- Implemented custom enterprise MarTech solutions across Adobe Experience Platform, Marketo, and Real-Time CDP
- Translated client needs into scalable technical solutions with integrated cross-channel data and targeted campaigns
- Collaborated with cross-functional consulting teams to engineer marketing automation and optimize performance impact

James Z. Wang Research Group

University Park, PA

Research Intern

January 2025 - Present

- Generated thousands of large-scale AI prompts via APIs to study cultural influences on emotional expression
- Managed high-throughput data pipelines producing extensive datasets for AI alignment analysis
- Synthesized AI outputs to investigate cross-cultural variations in emotional expression and inform alignment research

Kode With Klossy

Remote

Artificial Intelligence/Machine Learning Instructor Assistant

March 2025 - August 2025

- Taught basic machine learning principles to 40 high school students of underrepresented genders in technology
- Instructed on supervised learning, image classification, sentiment analysis, neural networks, semantic search, and RAG
- Guided students through deploying capstone projects using tools including Hugging Face, scikit-learn, and TensorFlow

Penn State School of Electrical Engineering and Computer Science

University Park, PA

Data Structures Grader

August 2025 - December 2025

- Graded Data Structures assignments in Python for over 200 students and provided actionable feedback
- Guided students through debugging and complex concepts, enhancing understanding and retention
- Collaborated with instructors to refine grading rubrics, streamline workflows, and maintain high-quality course delivery

PROJECTS

Rethread @ Google Solution Challenge (North America Finalist) | Next.js, React, Firebase, Tailwind

April 2026-Present

- Built full-stack fashion sustainability app in Next.js integrating 6 external APIs across a parallel server-side AI pipeline
- Designed Firebase integration with Google OAuth and Firestore atomic batch writes for user stat aggregation
- Architected serverless REST API with parallel async pipeline, in-memory caching, and rate limiting across 9 endpoints

Pixel Truth @ LAHacks (Honorable Mention) | Luau, Roblox Studio

April 2026

- Built Roblox game in Luau with event-driven client-server architecture, state synchronization, and modular backend logic
- Designed dialogue/scoring engine with dynamic UI updates driven by server-side events and shared data modules
- Shipped a full-stack interactive experience in 36 hours using collaborative version control workflows

AI Enterprise Readiness Advisor | React, Vite, JavaScript, Recharts

March 2026

- Implemented Google Gemini API calls to process multi-step inputs and return real-time analysis and recommendations
- Engineered structured prompt chaining to parse freeform client profile inputs into strict JSON schema outputs
- Designed dynamic data visualization, scoring dashboards, and transformation roadmaps using Recharts and React

LEADERSHIP & INVOLVEMENT

HackPSU

University Park, PA

Front-End Developer/Technology Organizer

September 2025 - Present

- Developed and maintained software for over 900 participants and internal organizers at Penn State's largest hackathon
- Implemented front-end features and API integrations in collaboration with design and back-end teams
- Streamlined project workflows through testing, debugging, and iterative improvements using CI/CD practices